

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1987-06-21

1 dear bahá'í friends,

2 . . . The outstanding success of the peace conference in finlandia hall

which your community sponsored last autumn remains one of the high-

3 lights among the various bahá'í peace events held throughout the world

4 since the issuance of The Promise of World Peace. The house of justice is

5 happy to know of your continuing effort to keep the subject of world peace before the
finnish people; however, it advises you to be careful in choosing

6 what such follow-up efforts should be and offers the following comments on your
specific question about promoting the idea of a world conference

7 of government leaders.

8 it is not advisable for bahá'í institutions or individuals to initiate ac-

9 tions designed to prod government leaders to urge their governments or the leaders
of other governments to convene the world conference called

10 for by bahá'u'lláh and echoed in The Promise of World Peace. Two points

11 should be borne in mind in this regard: (1) because of the political gravity

12 of the decisions implied by this call and the differing political attitudes

13 which it evokes, such actions on the part of the bahá'í community would

14 embroil the friends in partisan politics. There is quite a difference between

15 identifying, as does the peace Statement, the need for a convocation of

16 world leaders and initiating the political processes towards its realization. (2)

17 in the writings of the faith (e.g., the closing passages of The Promised Day

18 Is Come), it is clear that the establishment of the lesser peace, of which the

19 conference of leaders will be a related event, will come about independently of any
direct bahá'í plan or action.

20 The following reply was written on behalf of the beloved guardian in a

letter dated 14 march 1939 to an individual believer:31.1

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m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

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60 your view that the lesser peace will come about through the political

efforts of the states and nations of the world, and independently of

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any direct bahá'í plan or effort, and the most great peace established

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through the instrumentality of the believers, and by the direct opera-

tion of the laws and principles revealed by bahá'u'lláh and the func-

bahá'í Super State—your view on this subject is quite correct and in

full accord with the pronouncements of the guardian as embodied in

the “u n f o l d m e n t o f w o r l d c i v i l i z a t i o n . ” 31-1

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it is clear, then, that the friends must respect the prerogatives of political

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leaders in this matter and allow them the latitude to exercise the initiative

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that only they can effectively take towards the establishment of the lesser

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peace. The fact that bahá'í institutions will not be directly involved in the

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eventual convocation of the world leaders and in effecting the political

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unity of nations does not mean that the bahá'ís are standing aside and wait-

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ing for the lesser peace to come before they do something about the peace

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of humanity. indeed, by promoting the principles of the faith, which are

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indispensable to the maintenance of peace, by living the Teachings, and by fashioning the instruments of the bahá'í Administrative order, which we

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are told by the beloved guardian is the pattern for future society, the bahá'ís

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are constantly engaged in laying the foundation for world peace, the most

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great peace being their ultimate goal. The bahá'ís should do whatever they

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can within the context of their bahá'í teaching and consolidation plans and

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also through their professional and other regular activities to promulgate universal peace.

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it is a source of great satisfaction to the house of justice to see with

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what intensity the peace initiative of the bahá'í community is being pursued

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by the friends, who must now accelerate their activities at the grassroots level. The grassroots effort of the bahá'ís should prepare the ground for the

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transition from the present system of national sovereignty to a system of

54 world government. This it can do by concentrating on wide and continual
55 dissemination of the peace Statement whose contents should be known by
56 31-1. See wob, pp. 161–206.31.3a
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31 5
32 1986–1992 • T h e S i x Y e a r P l a n
33 61the generality of humanity, on engaging people from all walks of life in
34 discussions on peace, and on instilling and encouraging a sense of personal
35 commitment to the prerequisites of peace. in a word, what is needed now is
36 a worldwide consciousness of not only the requirements but also the possi-
37 bility and inevitability of peace. Therefore, our immediate and inescapable task as b
ahá'ís is to imbue the populations with such hope.
38 with loving b ahá'í greetings,

Department of tHe secretariat

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Requirements for Membership

in the Bahá'í Community

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]